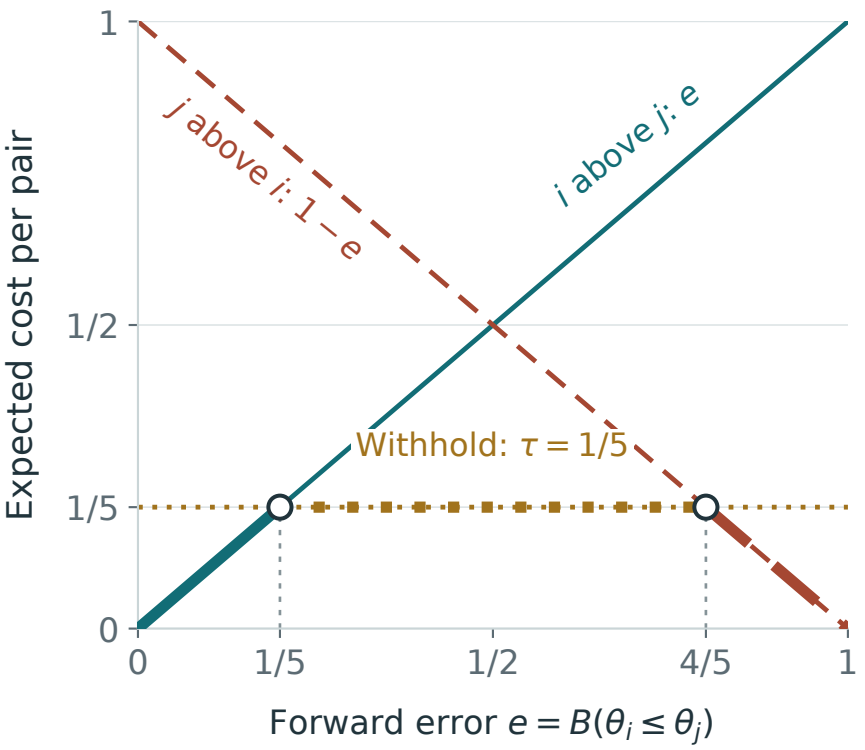
The isolated-pair decision

One scalar pair; no latent ties.
Cost per unordered pair (M = 1).



Thick segments: minimum cost

Unique minimizing action

$e < 1/5$: i above j

$1/5 < e < 4/5$: withhold

$e > 4/5$: j above i

At e = 1/5: i above j and withhold.
At e = 4/5: j above i and withhold.

Normalized source parameter
$\lambda = \tau/(1-\tau), \quad \tau = \lambda/(1+\lambda)$
$\tau = 1/5 \iff \lambda = 1/4$

Endpoint $\tau = 1/2$, $e = 1/2$:
$e = 1 - e = \tau = 1/2$
All three actions minimize.

Local thresholds do not bind every pair
in a coherent common grade.